Necromancer

Class Handbook

Your trusty class handbook for the Old Scrolls roleplaying game.



A necromancer seeks domination over death itself

Necromancer

Necromancers are often foul, evil magic users who have ignored the cautionary tales of the dangers of death magic and have sought out the ancient profane rituals of necromancy. The ultimate goal of most necromancers is the mastery over death itself, ascendency to eternal undeath and lichdom as the master of their own personal army of mindless servants.

Core Necromancer Traits

Primary Ability	Intelligence
Hit Points	8 at 1st level, 6 per level gained after 1st
Saving Throw Proficiencies	Intelligence, Wisdom
Skill Proficiencies	Choose any 2 skills. If you choose a skill you already have, you gain expertise with it.
Weapon Proficiencies	Choose 1: Blade, Blunt, Bow, Mechanical, Polearm, and Shield
Starting Equipment	Padded Jacket, Grimoire, Robe, Dagger

Necromancer Features Table

Level	Proficiency	Rituals	Class Features
1	+2	1	Master of Life and Death, Tools of Death
2	+2	2	Soul Sight, Bonus Ritual
3	+2	2	Death's Harvest, Tool of Death
4	+2	3	Ability Score Improvement, Bonus Ritual
5	+3	3	Endless Rituals
6	+3	4	Bonus Ritual
7	+3	4	Tool of Death, Unholy Vigor
8	+3	5	Ability Score Improvement, Bonus Ritual
9	+4	5	Unholy Endurance
10	+4	6	Bonus Ritual, Greater Heresy

Necromancer Features

As a necromancer, you gain the following class features when you reach the specified levels. These features are listed on the Necromancer Features table.

Level 1: Master of Life and Death

As a necromancer, you have learned to breach the barrier between life and death. You command the dead, allowing you to draw ancient spirits to serve you. These spirits animate corpses that your magic alters and strengthens.

Saving Throws. The saving throw DC of your necromancer features is 8 + your Intelligence modifier + your proficiency bonus.

Rituals. As a necromancer, you can call upon unquiet souls to do your bidding. You master blasphemous rituals, forbidden magics that allow you to animate the dead or call forth spirits from their slumber to serve you. You start with one ritual and learn more as you gain levels. When you gain a level, you can replace a ritual you know with a new one. Each ritual has a level. Your level must be greater than or equal to its level for you to take it.

Controlling the Dead. Each summoned undead creature provides a stat block, including the initiative it acts on. Undead do not roll initiative, they have static initiative. When you summon an undead creature, it appears within 30 feet of you. You decide their course of action, issuing a general command that they continue to fulfill. The undead can fulfill any task you wish, but lack specialized knowledge. You could not leave them in a forge and command them to make a sword, but they could assist by carrying water buckets, stocking a fire, and working the forge under your supervision. They lack the creative spark to create new things or work autonomously.

Soul Focus. When you use a ritual to create undead, it requires your soul focus. The next time you use another ritual, the one that needed your soul focus ends.

Level 1: Tools of Death

Your ability to pierce the veil between life and death allows you to craft objects infused with death energy. You gain two tools of death from among those listed at the end of this class.

Dark Arts. Many of your tools require an action to use. If you use your action to use a ritual, you can also use a tool that turn without using an additional action.

Level 2: Bonus Ritual

You gain an additional ritual.

Level 2: Soul Sight

As a magic action, you can perceive the flow of life and death around you. You can detect the presence of living and undead creatures within 60 feet. You do not learn their exact location, but you learn their number. This sight extends through physical barriers.

Level 3: Death's Harvest

Once per turn when a creature within 30 feet of you dies, you regain hit points equal to your Intelligence modifier.

Level 3: Tool of Death

You gain an additional tool of death.

Level 4: Ability Score Improvement

You gain a +1 bonus to two abilities of your choice.

Level 4: Bonus Ritual

You gain an additional ritual.

Level 5: Endless Rituals

At the start of your turn, any undead created by your currently active ritual that are destroyed return to unlife with full hit points.

Level 6: Bonus Ritual

You gain an additional ritual.

Level 7: Tool of Death

You gain an additional tool of death.

Level 7: Unholy Vigor

On your turn, you can gain a failed death save to grant all undead created by your rituals an extra action on their next turn.

Level 8: Ability Score Improvement

You gain a +1 bonus to two abilities of your choice.

Level 8: Bonus Ritual

You gain an additional ritual.

Level 9: Unholy Endurance

The first time you take damage while at 0 hit points each turn, roll a d20. On a 10 or higher, you do not take that damage and ignore all damage you would take for the rest of the turn.

Level 10: Bonus Ritual

You gain an additional ritual.

Level 10: Greater Heresy

You can now cast two rituals that require your soul focus, or you can use the same one twice to double the number of undead you can create.

Rituals

Rituals that require your soul focus note that in their duration entry.

Animate Mummy

Level 6 Ritual (Necromancer)
Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 30 feet
Duration: Permanent (Soul Focus)
You send a call deep into the realm of the dead to awaken the ancient, slumbering spirit of a long dead hero. The spirit manifests as a mummy that uses the stats below.

Animated Mummy

- **AC** 15
- **HP** 9 per necromancer level
- **Tests** +3 (Str +7)
- **Fearsome Presence.** Creatures attacked by the mummy are goaded by it for one round.
- **Initiative 5: Brutal Slams**
  - Two melee attacks
  - Attack bonus equal to your proficiency + your Intelligence modifier
  - 2d10 bludgeoning damage

Animate Skeletons

Level 2 Ritual (Necromancer)
Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 30 feet
Duration: Permanent (Soul Focus)
You conjure forth the spirits of slain warriors to animate skeletons of up to size Medium. Each skeleton has stats listed below. The number of skeletons you can animate depends on your level. If you invoke this ritual and already have skeletons animated with it, you animate additional ones until you reach your limit. You animate one skeleton at level 1, two at level 3, three at level 5, four at level 7, and five at level 9.

Animated Skeleton

- **AC** 16
- **HP** 8
- **Tests** +0 (Dex +2)
- **Death Splinters.** If killed by a melee attack, the creature that destroyed it takes 1d8 piercing damage.
- **Initiative 20: Slashing Claws**
  - One melee attack
  - Attack bonus equal to your proficiency + your Intelligence modifier
  - 1d6 slashing damage

Animate Zombies

Level 1 Ritual (Necromancer)
Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 30 feet
Duration: Permanent (Soul Focus)
You call forth spirits of the dead to animate nearby corpses that are up to size Medium. Each zombie has stats listed below. The number of corpses you can animate depends on your level. If you invoke this ritual and already have zombies animated with it, you animate additional ones until you reach your limit. You animate one zombie at level 1, two at level 3, three at level 5, four at level 7, and five at level 9.

Animated Zombie

- **AC** 12
- **HP** 12
- **Tests** +0 (Str, Con +2)
- **Death Proof (15+).** When reduced to 0 hit points by damage other than radiant, roll a d20. On 15+ this creature is instead reduced to 1 hit point.
- **Initiative 5: Rend and Tear**
  - One melee attack
  - Attack bonus equal to your proficiency + your Intelligence modifier
  - 1d8 bludgeoning damage

Call Death Knight

Level 10 Ritual (Necromancer)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 30 feet
Duration: Permanent (Soul Focus)

You send a call deep into the realm of the dead to awaken the ancient, slumbering spirit of a long dead hero. The spirit manifests as a death knight that uses the stats below.

Death Knight

- **AC** 18
- **HP** 9 per necromancer level
- **Tests** +4 (Str, Con, Wis +8)
- **Doom Reaper.** Can move through but cannot end a turn inside a solid object.
- **Initiative 15: Doom Blade**
  - Three melee attacks
  - Attack bonus equal to your proficiency + your Intelligence modifier
  - 2d10 slashing damage
- **Initiative 15: Unholy Fire**
  - Target point within 120 feet
  - Creatures within 20 feet of that point are affected
  - Dexterity save using necromancer's save DC
  - Failure: 6d6 fire damage
  - Success: Half damage

Call Wraith

Level 8 Ritual (Necromancer)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 30 feet
Duration: Permanent (Soul Focus)

You draw forth a hateful spirit into this realm. The spirit manifests as a wraith that uses the stats below.

Wraith

- **AC** 13
- **HP** 7 per necromancer level
- **Tests** +3 (Wis, Cha +6)
- **Incorporeal.** Can move through but cannot end a turn inside a solid object.
- **Insubstantial (16+).** The first time this creature takes damage on a turn, roll a d20. On a 16 or higher, this creature takes no damage that turn.
- **Fly.** This creature can fly.
- **Initiative 15: Life Drain**
  - One melee attack
  - Attack bonus equal to your proficiency + your Intelligence modifier
  - 2d10 necrotic damage, and a creature within 30 feet may regain 2d10 hit points

Call Wrathful Ghost

Level 4 Ritual (Necromancer)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 30 feet
Duration: Permanent (Soul Focus)

You draw the ghost of someone who died a painful death. The spirit manifests using the stats below.

Wrathful Ghost

- **AC** 13
- **HP** 5 per necromancer level
- **Tests** +1 (Cha +4)
- **Incorporeal.** Can move through but cannot end a turn inside a solid object.
- **Insubstantial (16+).** The first time this creature takes damage on a turn, roll a d20. On a 16 or higher, this creature takes no damage that turn.
- **Fly.** This creature can fly.
- **Initiative 10: Frightening Howl**
  - Hostile creatures in melee range must make saves
  - Wisdom save using necromancer's save DC
  - Failure: 1d4 psychic damage per 2 levels and frightened of the ghost for 1 round
  - Success: Half damage

Curse of Death's Doorstep

Level 6 Ritual (Necromancer)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 120 feet
Target: 1 creature
Duration: 3 rounds

You weave necromantic energy through a creature's spirit, sending tendrils into the future to draw its death hurtling toward it. The target creature gains a death curse, its life energy bleeding away each time death comes to call. Once per round when a creature within 30 feet of it dies, it takes 3d12 necrotic damage, or 4d10 at level 8.

Gaze of the Bloody Skull

Level 4 Ritual (Necromancer)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 30 feet
Duration: 1 round

The skin covering your skull peels back, revealing a horrid, bloody mask that leaves creatures shrieking in terror. Creatures of your choice within 30 feet of you must make Wisdom saves. On a failed save, a creature is frightened of you and cannot move closer to you.

Vampiric Harvest

Level 1 Ritual (Necromancer)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 120 feet
Target: 1 creature
Duration: 1 round

You infuse an aura of death energy around a creature, allowing you to collect its life energy and share it with an ally.

Once per turn when the target takes damage, you gain one blood point. At the start of your next turn when this spell's duration expires, a creature of your choice within range regains 3 hit points per blood point you collected. You then lose all blood points.

Tools of Death

If you lose a tool, you can craft another one as part of a long rest. The item is ready when the long rest ends. You can replace one tool for each long rest.

Death Mask

You weave a ghoulish mask from skin taken from an embalmed corpse. When you wear the mask you gain the following benefits.

When making Charisma checks to influence undead creatures, add your Intelligence modifier as a bonus to the roll.

As a magic attack action, you can stare at a creature within 120 feet and fill it with dread. It must make a Wisdom save. On a failed save, it is frightened of you for one round and takes psychic damage based on your level.

The damage is 1d4 at level 1, 2d4 at level 3, 3d4 at level 5, and 4d4 at level 8.

Death-Eyed Skull

You collect a skull and scribe it with blasphemous runes of death and annihilation. You can present the skull and channel power through it, causing a sickly beam of crimson energy to emit from it as a magic attack action. This is an attack against one target with a range of 120 feet that uses your Intelligence modifier on its attack and damage rolls. On a hit, the target comes under a death curse and suffers psychic damage based on your level. While cursed, undead creatures have advantage on attacks against it for one round.

The damage is 1d4 at level 1, 2d4 at level 3, 3d4 at level 5, and 4d4 at level 8.

Emissary Skull

You have the skull of a linguist and ambassador. Treated with runes, it retains a shadow of its former knowledge.

If the skull is daubed with blood or other remains taken from a slain creature, it gains the knowledge of all languages that creature speaks. You can speak, understand, and read those languages while you hold the skull. If you use this ability again, the skull loses the prior languages it learned, replacing them with the new ones.

Scythe of Reaping

You imbue a scythe with the energies that simmer between life and death. It becomes a cutting tool that you can use to reap life energy from your enemies. The scythe is a two-handed, reach melee weapon that does 1d6 slashing damage.

In your hands, the weapon uses your Intelligence modifier for its attack and damage bonus.

At higher levels, you gain reaper dice as the scythe's cuts open the gate between life and death. Your reaper dice are 1d6 at level 3, 3d6 at level 5, and 4d6 at level 8.

When you hit a hostile creature with the scythe, you can roll the reaper dice and apply the total as necrotic damage to the target of your attack or as healing to a creature within melee range of you.

Thief's Hands

You have acquired the severed hands of a dead thief and, with your magic, have imbued the thief's cunning into them.

The hands are two Tiny objects with AC 15, 2 hit points each, and a test bonus equal to your Intelligence modifier + your proficiency bonus. They have advantage on all Stealth checks. They have a climb speed.

As a magic action, you can direct them to open doors, search through treasure piles, and take other actions as you direct. As a search action, you can project your senses through one of them,

allowing you to see and hear everything it senses for one round.

The hands understand how to use lock picks and can be directed to pick locks and disable traps if they are carrying the appropriate tools.



The powers of necromancy are quite useful in the right hands